



# Muncie Parks Department Meeting January 21st 2025

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=03udJwNewzA">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=03udJwNewzA</a> |
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| Target Category  | muncie_city                                                                                           |

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## 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The Muncie Park and Recreation Board meeting was called to order on Tuesday, January 21st, by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Members Present:** Chamber Park, James Ludton, Mark Irvin, Shannon Power, and Brad Marshall.
  - **Presiding Officer:** Brad Marshall (identified via running the meeting/roll call direction).

## 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the previous meeting were presented. With no comments or discussion, a motion to approve was made and seconded, and the minutes were **Approved by Voice Vote**.

## 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:01:17 Superintendent Report

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Superintendent.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
  - Superintendent Malone reported on 2025 winter maintenance operations (working inside/outside based on weather, salting sidewalks, fixing picnic tables, benches, and maintaining equipment).
  - Discussed ongoing restroom challenges, including an incident where a person in motorized handicap equipment locked themselves inside a park bathroom to stay warm, raising safety concerns.
  - Noted unprecedented staffing shortages (5 openings simultaneously). Three positions have been filled, including Kelly Mandon, a 20+ year city employee, selected as the new Working Foreman to supervise Perry Creek and city parks. Two positions remain open (Assistant Urban Forester and Program Director).
  - Highlighted grants under review: the Pacers Foundation grant (for refurbishing the Heekin Park basketball court) and a National Parks and Recreation Association (NPRA) grant involving musco lighting (both reached the final/second round).
  - Addressed upcoming projects, including Riverview Park timeline coordination and Thomas Park water line repairs.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information report only; no formal board vote taken.

#### 00:14:14 Programming Report (Nikki)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nikki (Office/Programming representative).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
  - Provided updates on the rescheduled Youth Employment and Resource Fair (now set for February 8th and 9th at Minnetrista), featuring resume building, dress for success, financial literacy, and entrepreneurship workshops.
  - National Kids to the Park Day is scheduled for May 17th at Canan Commons.
  - NFL FLAG Football registration is underway in partnership with the NFL and Third and 11 (capping at 120 players, K<U+2013>6th grade, at Ball Corp).
  - Planning is underway with Northside for the summer program hub.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information report only.

#### 00:21:00 Prairie Creek Reservoir Report

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tony (Prairie Creek representative) & Carl Malone.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
  - Discussed seasonal prep, camp leases (due March 31st, with a late fee until April 4th before lottery switches), dock management, and safety training.
  - Addressed the wooden vs. floating docks; financing proposals for new floating docks are in progress with Jeff Huff from the bank.
  - Extensive discussion occurred regarding park security, law enforcement presence, jurisdictional arrest rights for officers at the reservoir, and budgeting for special

events.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information report only.

### 00:36:16 Amvets Post 12 / Catfish Pirates Fishing Tournament Event Approval

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tony / Prairie Creek Administration.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of the annual Amvets Post 12 Catfish Pirates fishing tournament event request, scheduled for Sunday, May 24th, from 8:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m. in the beach area near the first shelter (anticipating 300 participants as a veteran housing/home repair fundraiser). Board members raised questions regarding security requirements and insurance compliance under standard park contract language.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None specific to this vote outside of board inquiry.
- **Action & Vote Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote** (with the caveat that staff will verify security and insurance compliance prior to the event).

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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:42:50 Christy (Permanent Camper & Dock Holder):** Addressed the board regarding the Sailboat Club's restricted public access compared to regular public park areas, camper electrical limitations (inability to run multiple appliances like a/c and microwaves on current power, noting only 3 preferred sites have 50 amp service), and potential rate fairness.
- **00:48:59 Mike Foster (Resident / Local 103 Equipment Operator):** Suggested establishing a steering committee to evaluate major capital projects (such as electrical and water infrastructure upgrades at Prairie Creek) utilizing modern trenching equipment, grants, or utility partnerships. He also noted that slip renters and campers generate a substantial portion of the reservoir's revenue and questioned the equity of private club leases versus general camper accommodations.
- **00:59:16 Nathan Buck (Resident / Stakeholder):** Inquired about security budget execution (noting a prior \$75,000 budget line vs. lower spend) and advocated for municipal police patrol integration for city-operated parks to minimize supplemental security costs.

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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - Discussion on the new Working Foreman role (Kelly Mandon) and bridging operations between city parks and Prairie Creek.
  - Playground updates for Allshire and Westside parks.
  - Upcoming contract reviews for the YMCA pool and future truck fleet replacements.

- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made and seconded; **Approved by Voice Vote.**  
*(Exact closing time not explicitly stated on transcript).*
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